

How we work

What we sell, who does what, and the two rules that keep it from falling over. Written so neither of us needs to ask the other what something means.

What we sell, in four sentences

Germany has three rules for anyone selling to German shoppers. Most foreign brands break at least two of them without knowing.

We check a shop's website automatically, then Ornella checks one German register by hand. We put the findings in a three-page report and charge **€890** for it. If they want the problems fixed, that is a separate, larger job.

The three rules we check

SHORT NAME	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
Accessibility BFSG	A German law, in force since June 2025. An online shop must be usable by people with disabilities — someone who cannot use a mouse, or who uses a screen reader. The shop must also publish a short statement saying how accessible it is. Since January 2026 the German authority checks websites on its own initiative , not only when somebody complains.
Responsible person GPSR	An EU rule. A product may only be sold to EU customers if a named person or company <i>inside the EU</i> is responsible for it, and their contact details appear with the product. A brand shipping from outside the EU with nobody named is breaking this.
Packaging LUCID	German law. Anyone sending a parcel into Germany must register their packaging in a public register called LUCID <i>before</i> the first shipment, and pay a licence. This is the one we cannot check automatically — the register has to be searched by hand, in German. That is Ornella's job.

Who does what

The tools live on Ethan's laptop. Ornella never needs to install anything or type a command — everything reaching her is a spreadsheet or an email.

WHO	OWNS
Ethan	Building the list of companies to check, running the check, producing the reports, and fixing websites once someone buys.

WHO OWNS

Ornella Searching the German packaging register, all contact with prospects, all German-language work, the phone calls, and the relationships with the packaging providers.

Why it splits this way. Ethan's limit is how fast he can build. Ornella's limit is hours on the phone. Split like this, neither of us spends the day waiting for the other.

The week

DAY	ETHAN	ORNELLA
Mon	Add ~50 new companies to the list. Start the check running; it works overnight on its own.	—
Tue	Send Ornella the register worksheet.	Search LUCID for each company on it. Send it back.
Wed	Produce the reports, with her results already in them.	Start contacting the best prospects.
Thu-Fri	Fix websites for anyone who has bought.	Follow up. Take calls.
Fri	Twenty minutes together. Five numbers: checked, reported, contacted, replied, sold. One decision written down for next week.	

Ornella's first job — the register check

This is the one thing no software can do. The German packaging register is not machine-readable from outside, and it is in German.

ETHAN SENDS a spreadsheet

It arrives as a file called `_lucid-worklist.csv`. Despite the odd name, it is just a spreadsheet — double-click it, or open it in Google Sheets. One row per company, **best prospect at the top**.

Only companies worth searching are on it. If the check could not find a company name, or the web address turned out to belong to somebody else, that row is not there.

ORNELLA FILLS IN four columns

Everything to the left is already filled in. Search the LUCID register for the company in the `legalEntity` column, then complete these four:

COLUMN	WHAT TO PUT IN IT
<code>lucidStatus</code>	One of exactly three words: registered — found them in the register not_found — searched properly, they are not there unclear — could not tell. Two similar companies, a name that did not match, anything doubtful
<code>lucidNumber</code>	The LUCID number if there is one. Leave empty otherwise.
<code>checkedOn</code>	The date you searched, like <code>2026-08-16</code> . This date is printed in the report , so it matters.
<code>note</code>	Anything odd. Free text, only we read it.

When in doubt, write `unclear`. It is always the safe answer. The report then says the question is still open, which is honest. Writing **not_found** when you were not sure would put a claim in a paid document that we cannot stand behind.

One column to glance at: `identityConfidence`. If it says **medium**, the company name was found on a legal page but with no address next to it to confirm it. Worth a second look before searching.

ORNELLA SENDS it back

That is the whole job. Ethan drops the file in and the reports build themselves with your answers inside:

- **registered** → the report shows packaging as fine, and stops offering to fix it
- **not_found** → the report says *"We searched the public LUCID register on 16 August under [company] and found no registration"*
- **unclear** → the report says the question is still open
- left blank → the report says *register check pending*

Ornella's second job — the outreach

Your call on the wording. Four things that come from what we actually found.

Start with the ones who already know German law exists.

Some shops publish an Impressum but no accessibility statement. They already understand that German rules apply to them and have simply missed the newest one. That is a short, unembarrassing conversation.

The strongest fact we have is timing.

The German authority has been checking websites on its own initiative since January 2026. That is a better opening than a deadline that already passed in June 2025 — it is happening now, not overdue.

Never send the report itself in a first email. The report *is* the product. Send two or three findings and a number — *"324 serious accessibility problems, no accessibility statement, no EU responsible person named"* — which is alarming and impossible to act on. What they buy is the evidence, the explanation and the fix list.

Before the first hundred emails. Unsolicited business email is restricted in Germany under competition law, and the risk sits with the sender. Twenty minutes with a lawyer first. We are selling compliance; being on the wrong side of this would be expensive.

What we never say

This one matters more than it looks, and it applies to the reports, the emails and the phone calls.

We state the law. We state what we found. We never say what it means for them legally. We are not lawyers and we do not sell legal advice — saying otherwise is a regulated activity in Germany and we would be doing it without a licence.

NEVER WRITE OR SAY

SAY INSTEAD

~~You are not compliant~~

The law requires X. We found Y.

~~This makes you compliant · guaranteed ·
Abmahnungssicher · rechtssicher~~

These items are what we found and what it takes to address them.

~~You will be fined~~

The authority has been running its own checks since January 2026.

~~You are not registered for packaging~~

We searched the register on [date] under [company] and found no registration.

The report generator refuses to produce a document containing those words. It is not a suggestion — it will not build.

The two rules

1. Nobody gets contacted twice

Every company we touch gets a row in a shared spreadsheet called `pipeline.csv`, the same day — even the ones we rule out. Ornella owns it. It records the stage we have reached: contacted, replied, sold, or ruled out and why.

It is also what stops the tools re-adding a company we have already spoken to.

Ruled out for a good reason is fine and normal: too small (under 10 staff *and* under €2m a year, so the accessibility law does not apply to them), already doing everything right, or not really selling to Germany.

2. Nobody sends a report they have not read

A report takes one second to produce and a minute to read. The check is good but it is not a lawyer, and one wrong company name in a paid document costs more than the fee.

Words we use

The check / the scan

Software on Ethan's laptop that visits a shop's website and records what it finds. It behaves politely: public pages only, never logs in, never orders anything, waits a second between pages, and identifies itself.

Domain

A shop's web address, like `rains.com`.

CSV

A plain spreadsheet file. Opens in Google Sheets or Excel like any other.

Priority score

A number from 0 to 100 on the worksheet. High means two things at once: German law clearly reaches them, *and* they have a lot wrong. A shop with serious problems but no sign of selling into Germany scores near zero — it is not our customer at any price.

Serious problem / critical

An accessibility fault the software is confident about, like a form field with no label so a screen reader cannot say what it is for. The number is a **floor**, not a total: automatic checks find a minority of real barriers.

Impressum

The legal contact page German law requires of commercial websites. A foreign shop that has one already knows German rules apply to it.

Accessibility statement

A published page saying how accessible the shop is and how to report a problem. Required alongside the accessibility rules themselves. Most shops we check do not have one.

EN 301 549 / WCAG

The European technical standard the German accessibility law is measured against. In the report it lets us say precisely which rule a fault breaks.

Redirects to a different company

The web address now belongs to somebody else — sold, rebranded, or parked for sale. Those rows are dropped: sending a report about the wrong company is worse than sending none.

Check could not finish

A pop-up covered the page and the software could not see behind it. The result is marked unreliable and we do not use it.

If a term in a spreadsheet is unclear, ask before guessing. Everything on those sheets ends up in a document somebody pays for.

elbebridge GbR · Stormarner Straße 41 · 22049 Hamburg · hallo@elbebridge.com